



the edge of the box. Sustained pressure throughout the first-half from a possession-dominant City culminated in this breakthrough against an Everton side content to sit back.

But the tide turned soon after the break. Everton's xG (expected goals) surged to 2.54 in the second half — up from 0.22 in the first — with substitute Thierno Barry at the centre of the shift.

After City goalkeeper Gianluigi Donnarumma denied Iliman Ndiaye on a couple of early occasions in the second half, Barry equalised in the 68th minute. His effort — turning in Marc Guehi's weak back-pass to Donnarumma — was initially ruled offside but stood after referee Michael Oliver intervened, sending the Hill Dickinson Stadium crowd into raptures.

The host took the lead just five minutes later, with James Garner turning provider from a corner for Jake O'Brien's header. Everton took further advantage of a crumbling City backline as Barry completed his brace with a simple tap-in, leaving Guardiola stunned on the touchline.

By the 81st minute, visiting fans had begun heading to the exits. But moments after the restart, Erling Haaland chipped the ball past opposition goalie Jordan Pickford. This counter-attack made the City faithful linger a little longer, with hope in their hearts. That hope manifested into a result after Doku came up with another moment of brilliance, this time wrapping his right boot around the ball and finding the back of the net late in stoppage time.

Meanwhile, Manchester United returned to the Champions League with a 3-2 comeback win over Liverpool, ending a two-year absence from Europe's top flight. Matheus Cunha and Benjamin Sesko gave the Red Devils a two-goal lead inside 15 minutes before Dominik Szoboszlai and Cody Gakpo levelled for the defending champion. Kobbie Mainoo's 77th-minute winner lifted third-placed United to 64 points, six clear of Liverpool.

At the other end of the table, Wolverhampton Wanderers and Burnley were relegated, while Tottenham Hotspur and West Ham

Elite return: Kobbie Mainoo's 77th-minute winner lifted third-placed Manchester United to 64 points, six clear of Liverpool, as the Red Devils sealed a return to the Champions League after a two-year absence.

REUTERS

United remain locked in a tight battle to avoid the drop. Tottenham sits 17th with 37 points from 35 games, just one ahead of West Ham.

Over at the second-division of English football, Frank Lampard's Coventry City clinched the title to secure a return to the Premier League after 25 years. Second-placed Ipswich Town also earned promotion, a year after being relegated. Millwall, Southampton, Middlesbrough and Hull City will contest the playoffs, while Wrexham missed out on the top six by two points.

La Liga

Mathematics is all that keeps Real Madrid in the title race, with any slip set to hand Barcelona a successful title defence. The Catalans have 88